



Hacker Summer Camp 34

Random things slightly related.

September 24, 2026

If you want to do something that's going to change the world,
build software that people want to use
instead of software that managers want to buy.

— Jamie Werner Zawinski[1]

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Attempting to follow the recommendations or implement the ideas in this paper may not fit your context, may not solve your problem, and may in certain circumstances plunge your program and career into abject chaos.

I. STATISTICS

Hacker Summer Camp,TM for this year has concluded. Therefore in retribution to the spirit of such an event, let us reduce it down to a meaningless statistic, as such would be standard of such an institution that instills the retrograde prerogative in our youth, Academia.¹ In the their spirit I bring some random statics I thought would be interesting, although are meaningless.

The following figure shows data collected about the Volume of Talks. The data set is explained in Appendix A.2.

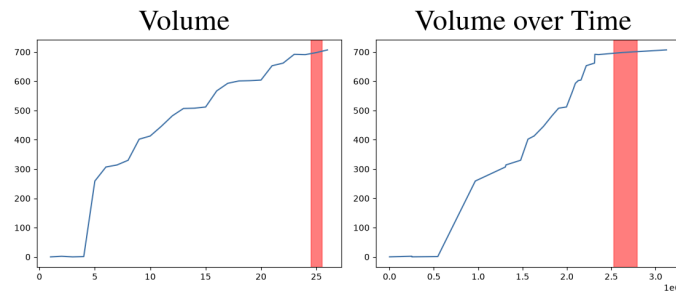


Fig. 1.² Data from Appendix A.2

This next figure shows information about the attence at the conference. The data set used is expounded is Appendix A.1.

¹Do **note**, however, that this is not me expousing my distain for academic and education institutions, just mocking some compatriots.

²The red highlight is during the time of the event. The vertical axis indicates the amount of talks. The horizontal axis in the first graph is the index of the data collected. The horizontal axis in the second graph is the time in seconds for each data point, subtracted by 1783471928 (to have the first point be at zero).

Approx. Attendance

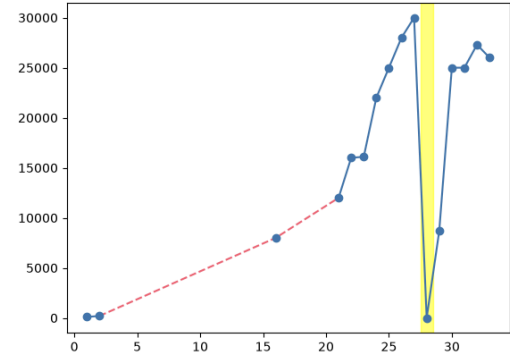


Fig. 2.³ Data from Appendix A.1

II. QR CODE

The badge for this year included a camera that scanned qr codes. The scanning is used for mainly two things: conference mode and token mode. Token mode allows the badge to be used as a hardware password manager. It takes a qr code to: set the clock, lookup/set a password, or add TOTP token.⁴

Based on the official guide for the badge, it is suggested you download an extension for the password management. Its a pretty basic extension that does two things in one qr code: sets the time and looks up the current site.⁵ The format for each is as follows:

```
$ # For time, you can set it in this format
$ date '+time:\\%Y-%m-%dT%H:%M:%S%:z'
time://2026-08-07T10:00-07:00
```

```
# For passwords you can use this format
pwauth://pass/https://septembersend.github.io
```

```
# You can do both with this format
pwauth://pass/https://septembersend.github.io?time=
2026-08-07T10:00-07:00
```

This format can be found out by looking at the extensions source code, which you can find by looking at the suport site for the extension. You can, if you want to, create your own version.⁶

³The yellow highlight indicates attendance during 2020 (DC28). The red dotted lines indicated missing data.

⁴There is a good site for a good local badge workbench: defcon.nsakek.com. It includes chaning the screen image, a serial console, qr tools, light lab (for conference mode), and more.

⁵It should be noted that this also can setup a entry in the manager, by setting up the name and auto generating a password.

⁶As for the conference mode, there are better analyses of the genetics simulated (for example: dc34sim.com and Andrew Mohawk).

III. HACKER TRACKER

A nice skill to have is the ability to directly be able to interact with websites. This can be done in many ways, but in this example, we will be interacting with Hacker Tracker's (HT) REST⁷ API. As a consequence, I will not reveal any specifics of the API used, you will have to find that out yourself.

The easiest way to find an API is through the network tab in the developer tools. All you have to do is look for the request that is sent in response to your actions.⁸ Once you can find that data, you can copy that value in a multitude of replication methods.

With that data you can do some interesting things. For HT, you can get the current data and *process it yourself in a better format*,⁹ or just notify you when a change is posted:

```
# Run every 15 minutes
curl "<endpoint>" -o newfile
if ! cmp newfile oldfile; then
    echo "was updated"
    mv newfile oldfile
fi
```

APPENDIX A: DATA SETS USED

The data sets are displayed using the *python library matplotlib*.

APPENDIX A.1: ATTENDANCE DATA SET

Attendance data was taken from wikipedia. This is not the most accurate, and some of the data is not reported or cited, but seems to be the most complete. The following is the exact data used.

#	Att.	#	Att.	#	Att.	#	Att.
1	100	2	200	16	8000	21	12000
22	16000	23	16000	24	22000	25	25000
26	28000	27	30000	28	0	29	8700
30	25000	31	25000	32	27300	33	26000

APPENDIX A.2: CUSTOM DATA SET

The data set used for the visualisations that where custom collected was specifically collected for the *Official Talk* and *Creator Talk/Panel* tags over time. So this will have different numbers compared to other data sets.

⁷First, an API is a method of communication between a computer or computer system. A REST (Representational State Transfer) API, is a type of API (Application Programming Interface). REST uses data of http(s) to facilitate communication.

⁸Do note that some of the api's may only be called once to retrieve the data. This means that the site may be caching its data locally.

⁹I have a **very** basic setup of such an idea.

This set of data was collected from the *hacker tracker* instance for the event. The data was gathered every 15 minutes so the times could be incorrect by chunks of 15 minutes, along with other inaccuracies that come with the method of collection. The set of data revealed will have the titles of the events held by the tags searched for. Duplicates shown in the data will have also been removed.

APPENDIX B: OTHER

- Networking Team – noc.defcon.org
- Events Hacker Tracker – info.defcon.org
- Events Media Server – media.defcon.org
- Events Transparency Report – defcon.org/html/links/dc-transparency.html
- Data Analysis and Visualization – github.com/derailable/defcon-insights
- DC34 Badge Help – defcon.org/34b
- DC34 Badge Vault App – github.com/bunnie/dc34-vault
- Local Badge Workbench Site (unofficial) – defcon.nsakek.com
- DC34: Badge hackin' – andrewmohawk.com/2026/08/16/dc34-badge-hackin'
- DC34 Gene Mate – andrewmohawk.com/tools/dc34-gene-mate
- DC34 Ligth Changer – atcasanova.github.io/DEFCON-34-badge-firmware
- QR Code Extension – github.com/baochip/qr-url-extension
- DC34 Badge Genetics – dc34sim.com

References

- [1] J. W. Zawinski, "Groupware Bad," Feb. 2005, [Online]. Available: <https://www.jwz.org/doc/groupware.html>
- [2] "DEF CON - Wikipedia." [Online]. Available: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/DEF_CON
- [3] R. H. Ellaway, "Disclaimers," *Advances in Health Sciences Education*, vol. 28, no. 4, pp. 1017–1021, Oct. 2023, doi: 10.1007/s10459-023-10286-z.